Support Tickets and Log Analysis

Project: *Okta Identity Lab |* ***Author:*** *Ismayeel Khan |* ***Date:*** *October 21, 2026 |* ***Environment:*** *Okta Integrator Free Plan*

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1. Goal

The goal of this checkpoint was to act like a helpdesk technician: create five realistic support problems, find the cause in the System Log, fix each one, and confirm the fix.

2. My Method

I used the same five steps for every ticket:

1. **Identify:** what is the user reporting, and what do I see myself?
2. **Check the log:** what does the System Log say happened?
3. **Find the root cause:** why did it happen?
4. **Fix:** change the one thing that is wrong.
5. **Verify:** confirm that the user can now do what they could not do before.

These are simulations. I created each problem myself, so I knew the cause in advance. I still worked from the symptom to the log to the cause, as I would on a real ticket.

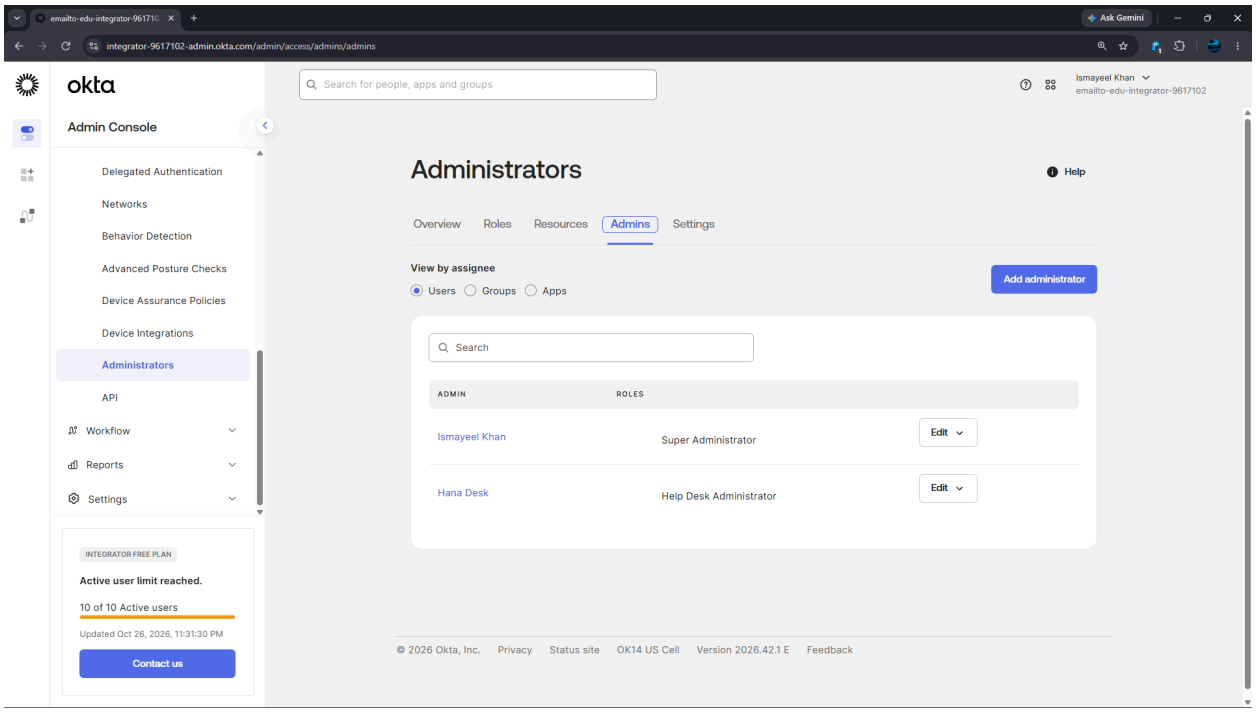
3. Summary of the Five Tickets

#	User	Reported issue	Root cause	Fix
1	Karan Patel	"I can't log in"	Account was suspended	Unsuspended the account
2	Aman Verma	"I forgot my password"	Password needed an admin reset	Created a temporary password with a forced change
3	Meera Joshi	"My app disappeared"	She had been removed from the IT group	Added her back to the IT group

#	User	Reported issue	Root cause	Fix
4	Rohan Mehta	"Is someone trying to get into my account?"	One typing mistake, not an attack	No action needed after reading the log
5	Neha Singh	"I lost my device"	Her passkey was no longer available	Reset her authenticator

4. Who Should Fix These?

In a real company, the helpdesk admin would handle these tickets. I created a **Help Desk Administrator** account for that in Checkpoint 2.



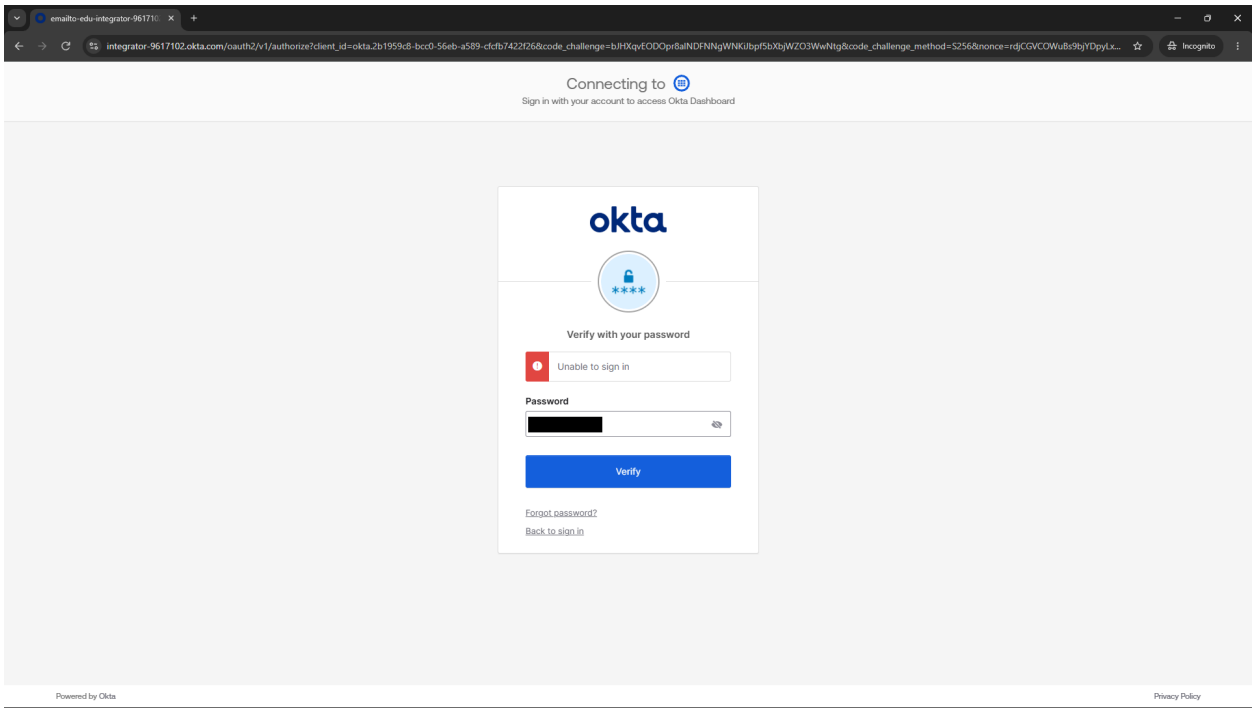
Administrators page: Super Administrator (me) and Help Desk Administrator (Hana Desk).

In this lab, I did the fixes from the **Super Administrator** account, because the helpdesk account could not finish its second-factor sign-in in my lab setup. Every entry in the System Log shows my name as the person who made the change. In a real company, these fixes would be done by the Help Desk Administrator role, which has less power.

5. Ticket 1: "I Can't Log In" (Karan Patel)

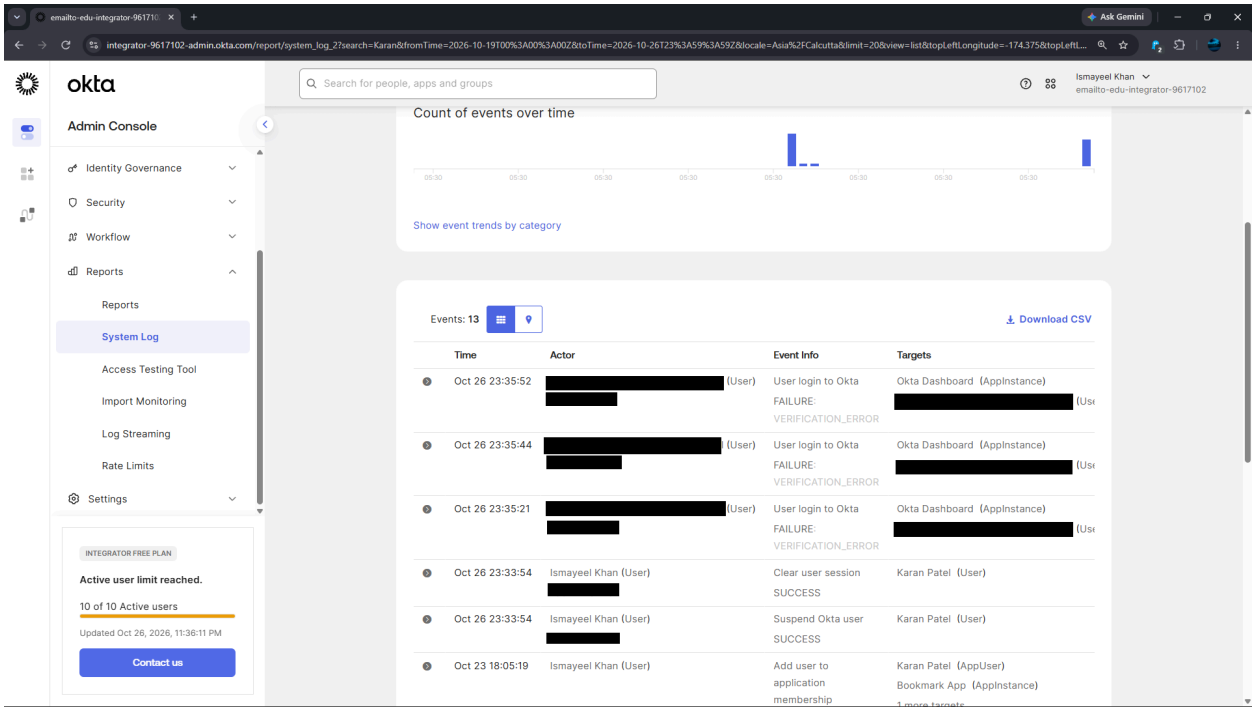
Field	Details
Reported issue	Karan cannot sign in to Okta.
Impact	One user is blocked from all of his apps.
Log evidence	Repeated failed sign-ins, plus a suspend event on his account.
Root cause	His account status was **Suspended**.
Fix (and who)	Unsuspended the account. Done from the Super Administrator account.
Verification	Karan signed in and saw his dashboard.
Time to resolve	About 2 minutes from the time of his first failed attempt to the time he signed in successfully

Identify. I set up the problem by suspending Karan's account. Then I tried to sign in as Karan and got the error "Unable to sign in."



Karan's sign-in attempt fails with "Unable to sign in." (Password field blacked out.)

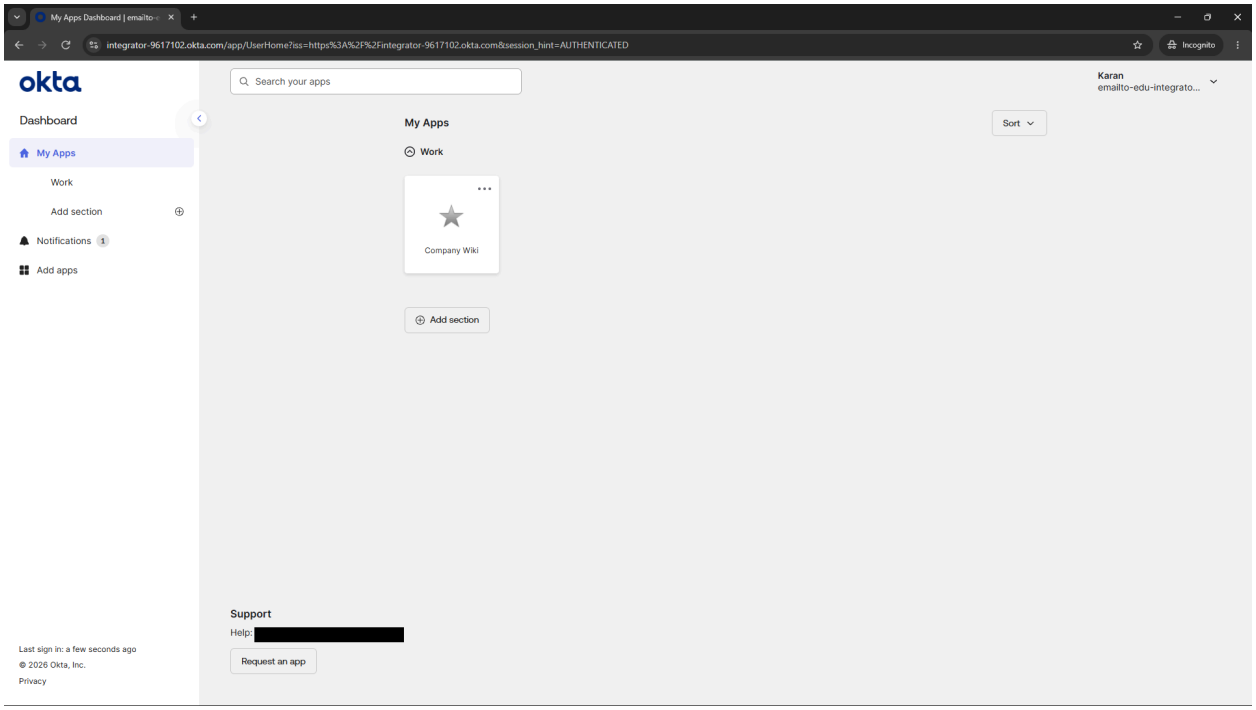
Check the log. I searched the System Log for Karan. It shows three failed sign-in attempts to the Okta Dashboard. Before them are two events from my admin account: **Suspend Okta user** and **Clear user session**, both successful.



System Log: Karan's account was suspended, then his sign-in attempts failed. (IP addresses and emails blacked out.)

Root cause and fix. The log and his profile both pointed to the same thing: the account was suspended. I used **More Actions > Unsuspend** on his profile.

Verify. Karan could sign in again. As a new user, he first had to set a new password. His dashboard then showed the Company Wiki.



Karan's dashboard after the fix.

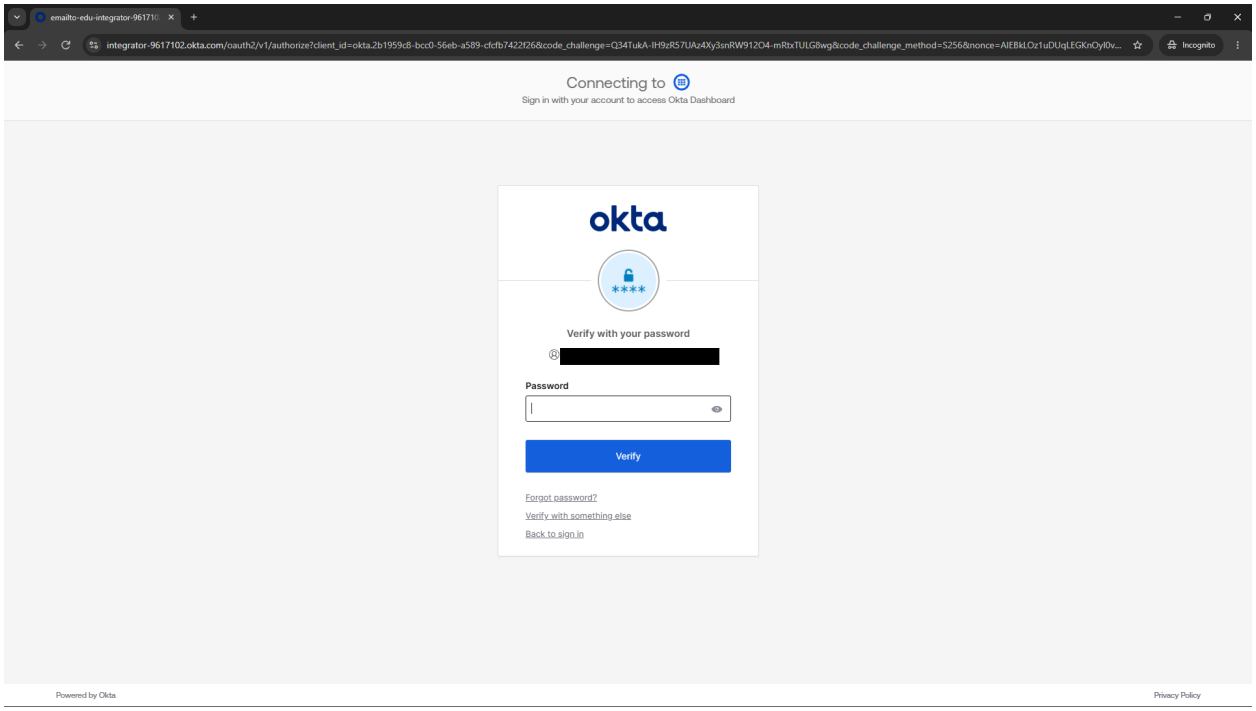
6. Ticket 2: "I Forgot My Password" (Aman Verma)

Field	Details
Reported issue	Aman cannot remember his password.
Impact	One user cannot sign in.
Log evidence	Password expired event, then the new password and email verification.
Root cause	The user does not know his current password.
Fix (and who)	Created a temporary password that must be changed at next sign-in. Done from the Super Administrator account.
Verification	Aman signed in with the temporary password, set a new one, and reached his dashboard.
Time to resolve	About 2.5 minutes, from the admin password reset (12:32 AM) to Aman's successful sign-in (12:35 AM), based on the System Log**.**

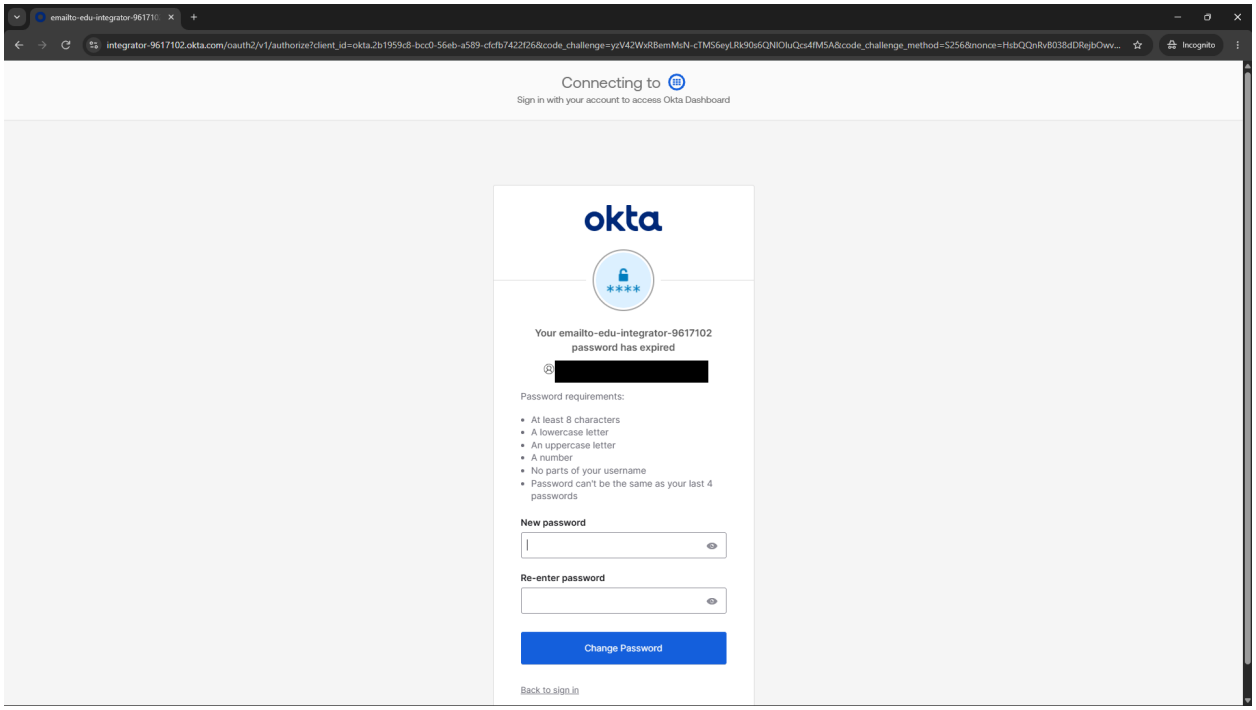
Identify. The ticket text was: "User reports a forgotten password." Before resetting anything, a real helpdesk would verify the person's identity, for example by calling them back or getting approval from their manager. Resetting a password for the wrong person is exactly what attackers try to get helpdesks to do.

Fix. On Aman's profile, I used **Reset Password**. Okta offered two choices: **send a reset password email**, or **create a temporary password**. I chose the temporary password, because it gets the user back in right away and does not depend on the email arriving.

Verify. Aman signed in with the temporary password. Because it was a one-time password, Okta immediately asked him to choose a new one, and showed the password rules: at least 8 characters, a lowercase letter, an uppercase letter, a number, no part of the username, and not one of his last four passwords.

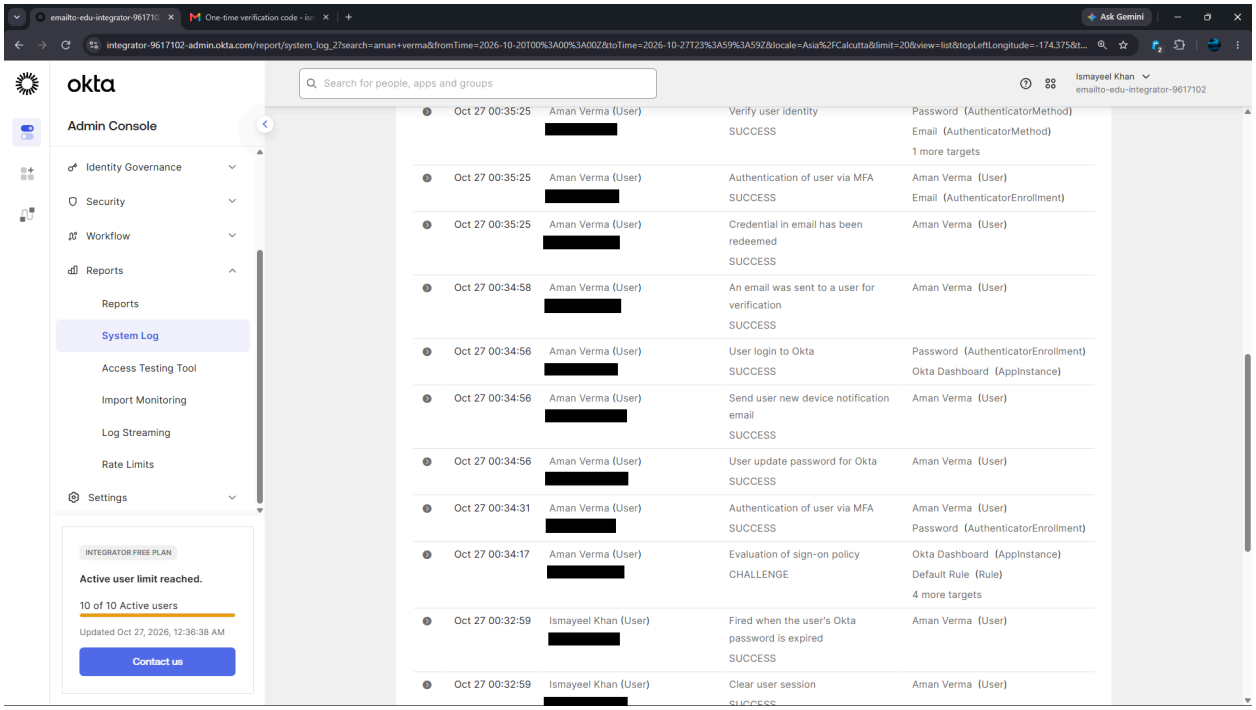


Aman signs in with the temporary password.



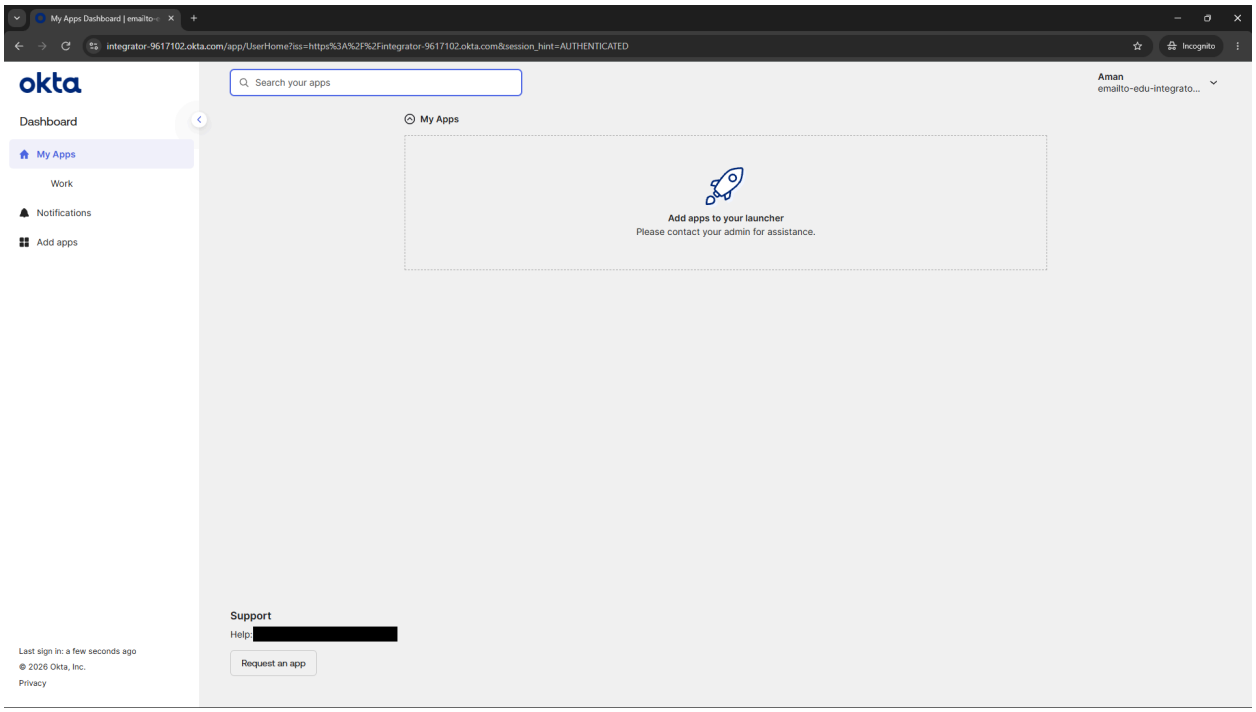
Okta forces Aman to set a new password.

Check the log. The System Log shows the whole story in order. My admin account expired his password and cleared his old session. Then Aman signed in: Okta challenged him, he updated his password, and Okta sent a "new device" notification email, which exists because I turned notification emails on in Checkpoint 4. He then passed email verification, and the log shows the sign-in success.



System Log for Aman's password reset and sign-in. (IP addresses blacked out.)

Aman is in the HR group, and no apps are assigned to HR in this lab, so his dashboard is empty. That is expected. It is not a fault.



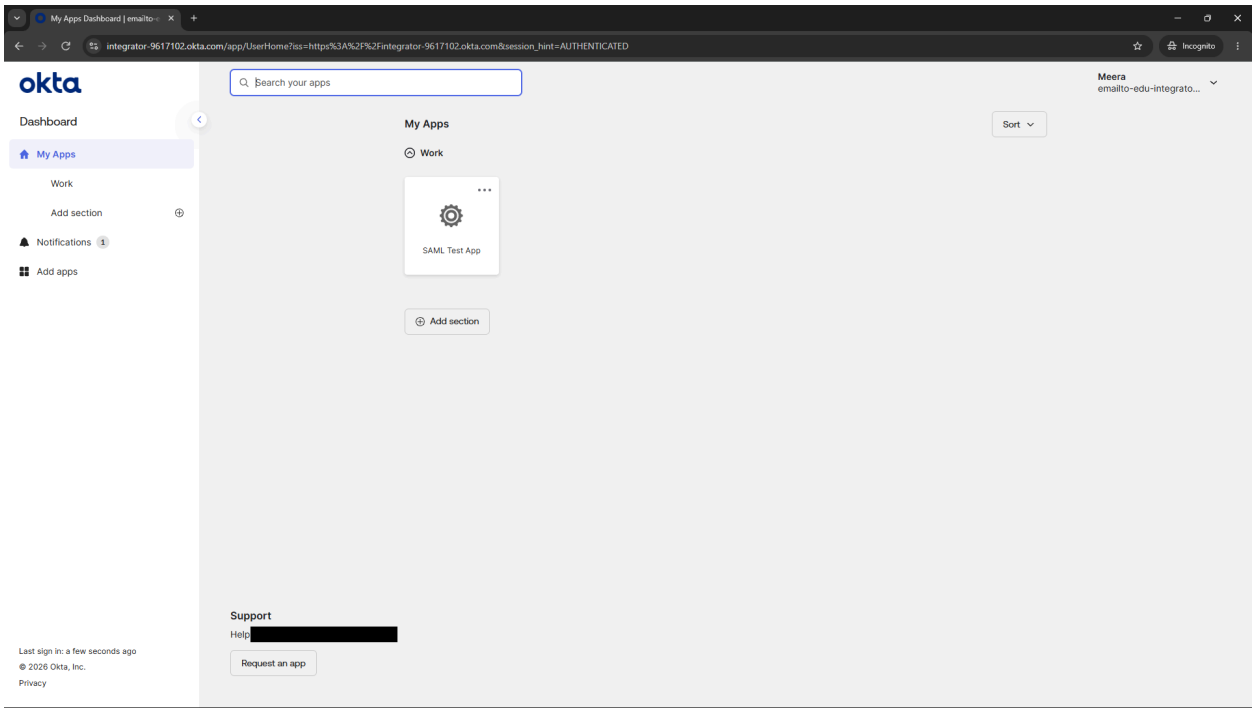
Aman's dashboard after signing in. HR has no apps assigned in this lab.

Real-world note. A temporary password should be given to the user over a verified channel, such as a call-back or the manager, never in an open chat. It should work only once and force a change.

7. Ticket 3: "My App Disappeared" (Meera Joshi)

Field	Details
Reported issue	Meera says an app she used to see is gone from her dashboard.
Impact	One user lost access to an app she needs.
Log evidence	Group membership shows the cause. No error in the log.
Root cause	She was no longer in the **IT** group, which is what gives access to the SAML Test App.
Fix (and who)	Added her back to the IT group. Done from the Super Administrator account.
Verification	The app tile came back on her dashboard.
Time to resolve	About 5 minutes

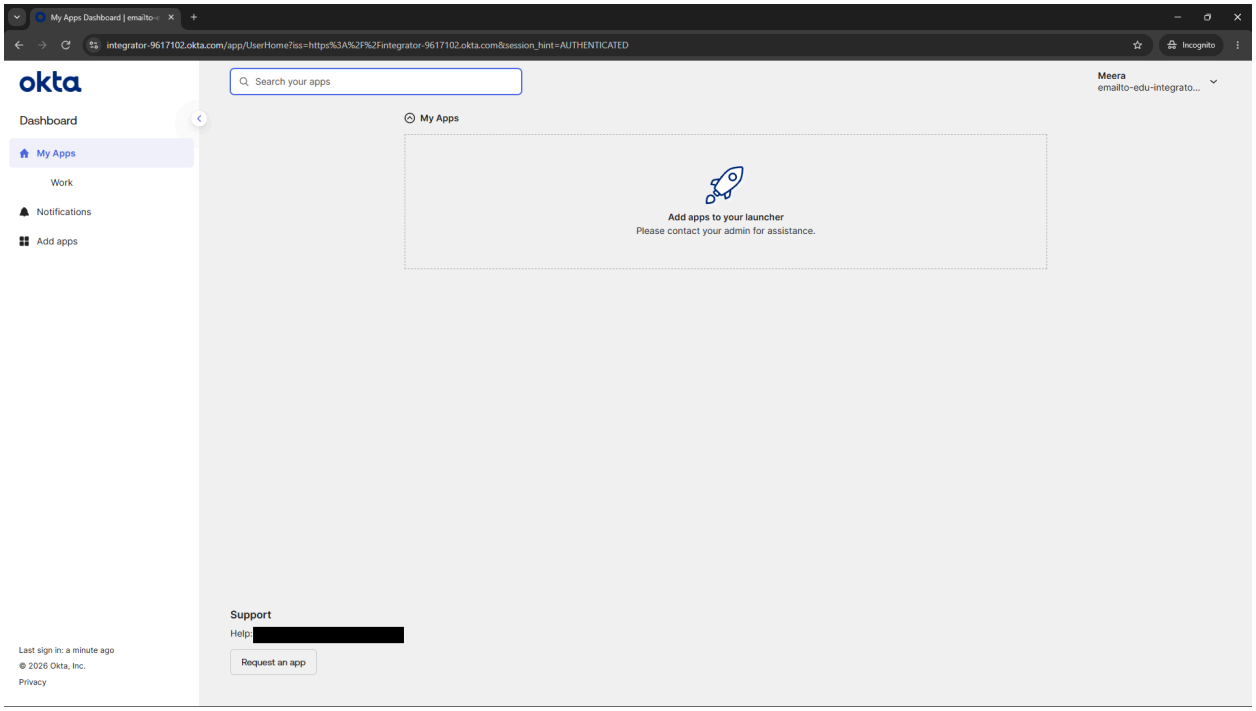
Before. Meera's dashboard showed the SAML Test App.



Before: Meera's dashboard with the SAML Test App.

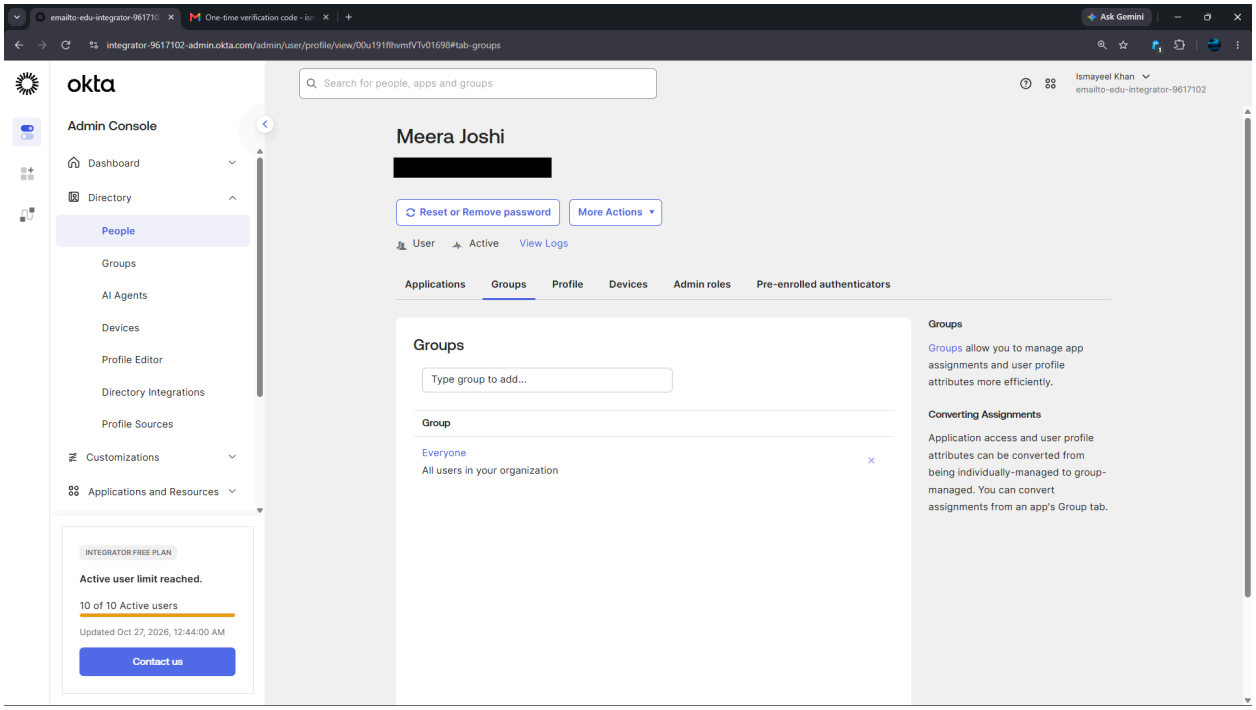
Create the problem. I removedMeera from the IT group.

Identify. Her dashboard was empty, with the message "Add apps to your launcher. Please contact your admin for assistance."



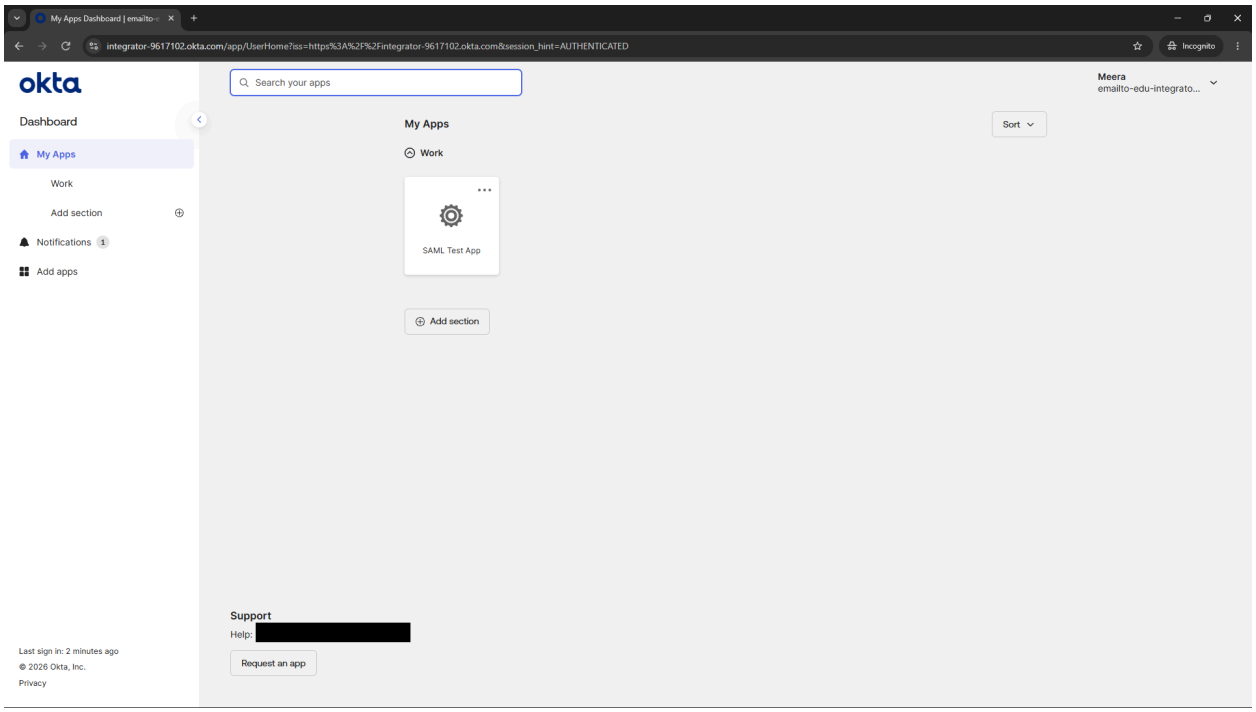
Problem: Meera's dashboard is empty.

Find the root cause. I did not guess. I opened Meera's **Groups** tab. It showed only the built-in Everyone group. The IT group was missing.



Root cause: Meera's groups no longer include IT. (Email address blacked out.)

Fix and verify. I added her back to the IT group. After she refreshed her dashboard, the tile returned.



After: the SAML Test App is back on Meera's dashboard.

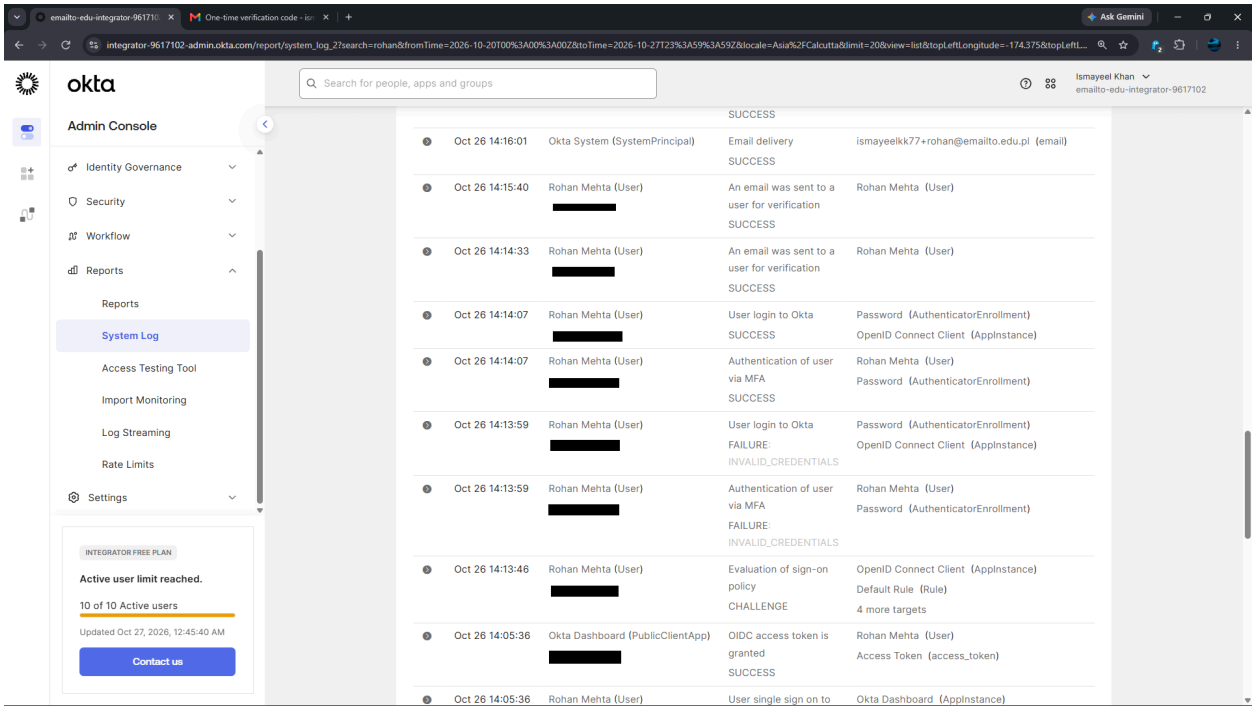
Lesson. When an app disappears and nothing shows as an error, check group membership first.

8. Ticket 4: "Is Someone Trying to Get Into My Account?" (Rohan Mehta)

Field	Details
Reported issue	Rohan sees a failed sign-in on his account and wants to know if it is an attack.
Impact	None found.
Log evidence	One failed password (INVALID_CREDENTIALS), then a successful sign-in 8 seconds later from the same place.
Root cause	A typing mistake by the user.
Fix (and who)	None needed. I explained the result.
Verification	The log shows the same IP address for the failure and the success.
Time to resolve	Less than 3 minutes of log review.

Check the log. I searched the System Log for Rohan. The relevant events, in order:

1. **Evaluation of sign-on policy: CHALLENGE** (Okta asks for proof)
2. **User login to Okta: FAILURE, INVALID_CREDENTIALS** (wrong password)
3. **User login to Okta: SUCCESS** (right password, 8 seconds later)
4. Verification emails sent



System Log: one failed password, then a success from the same IP address. (IP addresses blacked out.)

Analysis. One failure followed by a success a few seconds later from the same place is a typing mistake, not an attack. In this case I was the person who mistyped, so I knew the answer. I still read the log as if I did not.

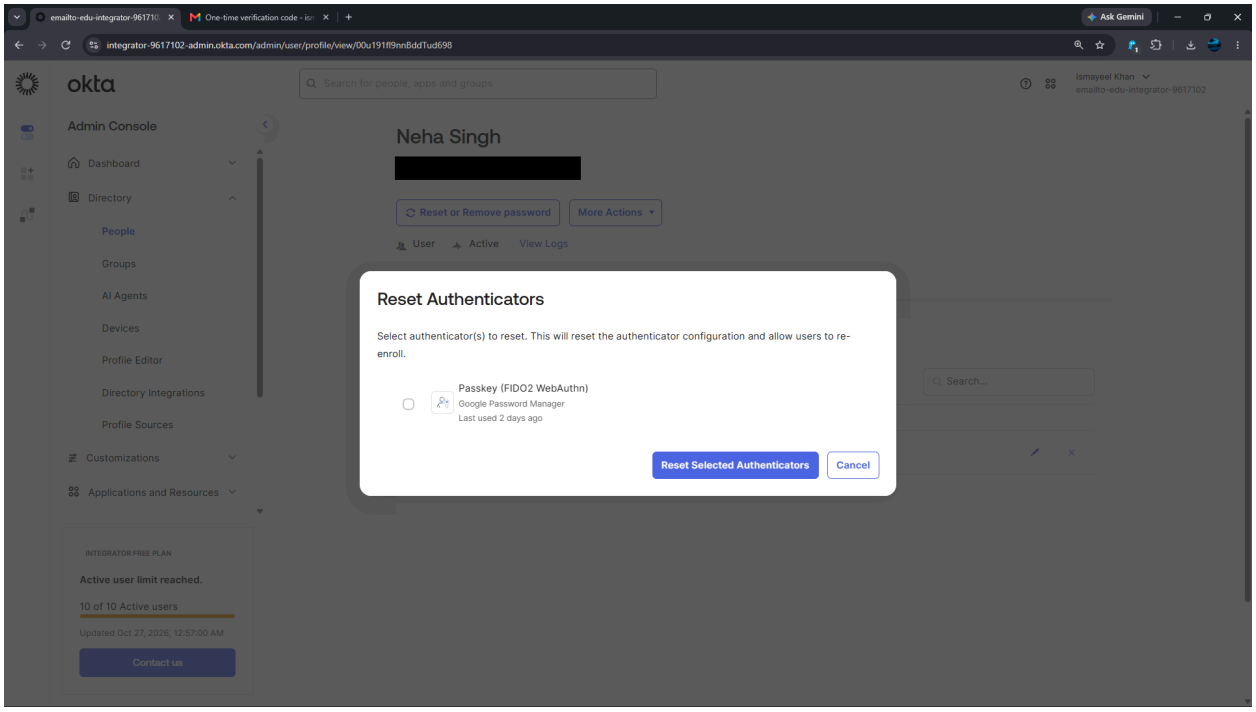
Red flags that would change my conclusion: many failures in a row, failures from several different IP addresses or countries, or attempts at odd hours.

9. Ticket 5: "I Lost My Device" (Neha Singh)

Field	Details
Reported issue	Neha lost the device that holds her passkey and cannot complete the second step of sign-in.
Impact	One user may be locked out of apps that require a second factor.
Log evidence	Authenticator reset by an admin, then a sign-in using password plus email.

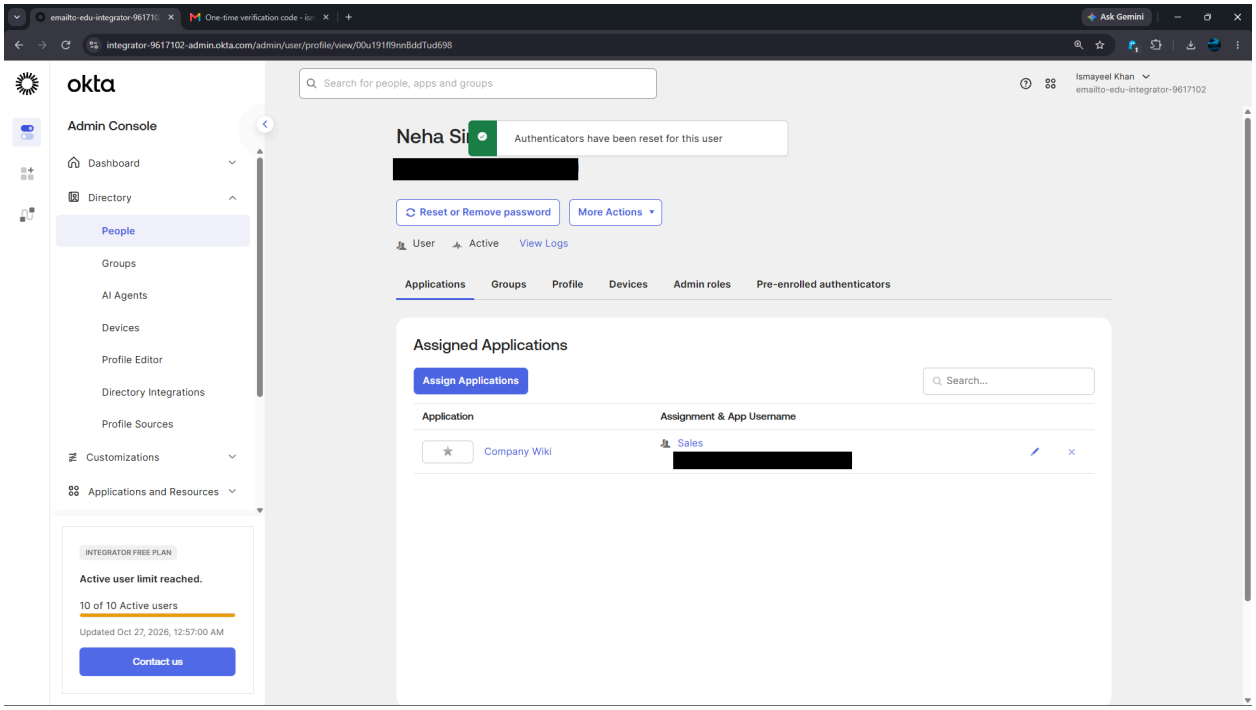
Field	Details
Root cause	The registered authenticator (a passkey) was no longer available to her.
Fix (and who)	Reset her passkey enrollment so she can re-enroll. Done from the Super Administrator account.
Verification	Neha signed in again with her password and an email code.
Time to resolve	About 5 minutes

Fix. On Neha's profile, I opened **More Actions > Reset Multifactor**. Okta listed her one registered authenticator: a **Passkey (FIDO2 WebAuthn)** stored in Google Password Manager, last used two days earlier. Resetting it deletes only that enrollment. It does not change her password or her account.



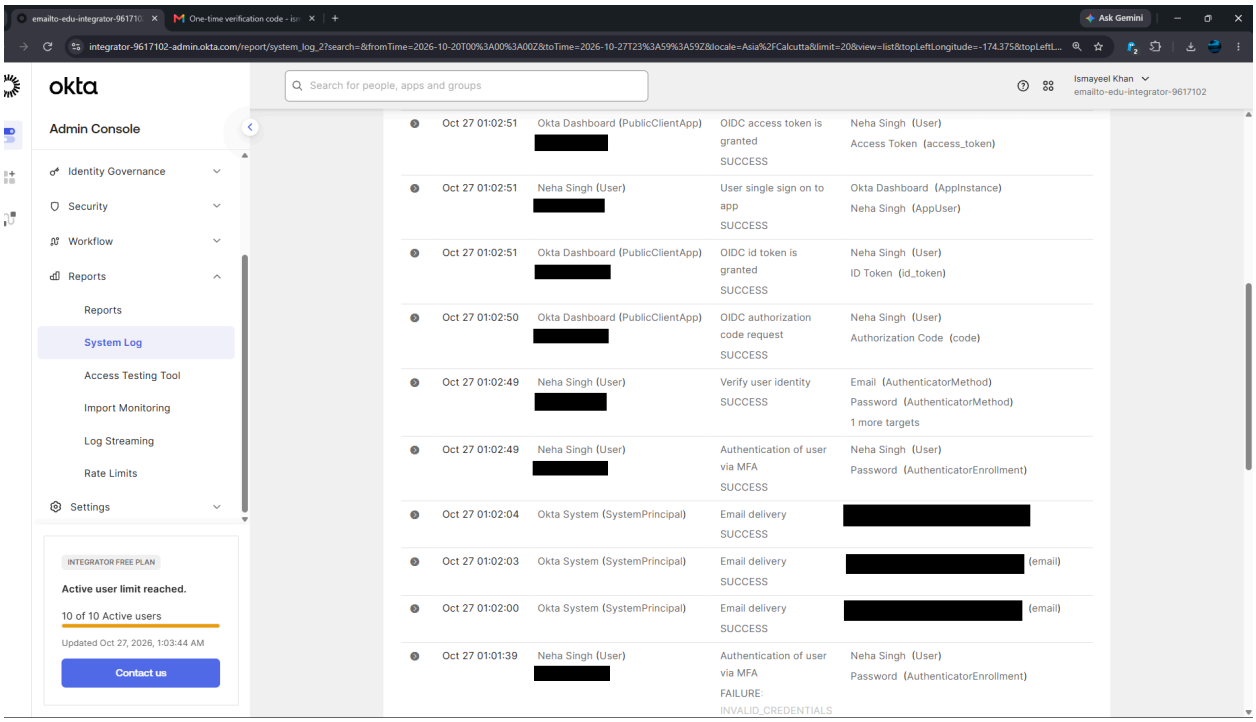
Reset Authenticators: Neha's passkey. (Email address blacked out.)

Okta confirmed with the message "Authenticators have been reset for this user."



Confirmation that Neha's authenticators were reset. (Email address blacked out.)

Verify. Neha signed in again. The System Log shows her password was accepted, then she verified with an email code, and the dashboard sign-in succeeded.



System Log: Neha's sign-in after the reset, using password and email. (IP addresses and email addresses blacked out.)

Okta did not make her set up a new passkey. That fits my setup, because Passkey is **optional** in my enrollment policy and Email is the required factor.

Real-world note. "I lost my phone" is a favorite trick of attackers who call helpdesks pretending to be someone else. Before resetting MFA, a real helpdesk verifies the person's identity first, for example with manager approval or a call-back.

10. How to Read the System Log

These are the event types I used most:

Event	What it means
Evaluation of sign-on policy: CHALLENGE	Okta is asking the user to prove who they are
Evaluation of sign-on policy: ALLOW	The rules are satisfied, so access is granted
User login to Okta: SUCCESS / FAILURE	A password sign-in worked or did not
INVALID_CREDENTIALS	The wrong password was entered
Suspend / Unsuspend / Deactivate Okta user	An admin changed an account's status
Clear user session	A user's open sign-in was ended
User attempted unauthorized access to app	The user is not assigned to that app

The log always lists who did it, what happened, from which IP address, and whether it succeeded.

11. Problems I Ran Into

- **The helpdesk account could not finish its sign-in.** It was asked for a second factor that I could not complete in my lab, so I did the fixes from the Super Administrator account.
- **My temporary inbox stopped showing messages.** Email verification depends on the inbox, so I created a new email address and switched the affected users to it. **[ADD or edit this sentence so it matches exactly what you did.]**

- **Some Okta screens differed from what I expected.** For example, the Reset Password dialog offered a temporary-password option that I used, because the reset email would not have reached me.

12. Key Concepts I Learned

- **A repeatable method beats guessing:** identify, check the log, find the cause, fix, verify.
- **Read the log before blaming the user or the system.**
- **Check group membership first** when an app is missing.
- **Verify identity before resetting passwords or MFA.**
- **Not every FAILURE is an attack:** context decides.
- **Least privilege matters in support, too:** a Help Desk role should handle these tasks, not a super admin.

13. Limits and Notes

- These are simulated tickets. I created each problem myself.
- The fixes were done from the Super Administrator account, not the helpdesk account.
- I did not capture a screenshot of Neha's dashboard after her sign-in. The System Log is my evidence.
- All users and data are fake.

14. What I Learned and Next Steps

The main lesson from this checkpoint: **find the cause in the log before you change anything, and verify the fix afterward.**

This completes the lab. Across six checkpoints, I set up an Okta org, built a small company with groups and users, connected apps with SSO, protected sign-ins with MFA, ran the joiner-mover-leaver life cycle, and solved five support tickets using the System Log.